

Eight ways to lose a day

Each of these has already happened once on this production or is one obvious step away from it. They are cheap to avoid and expensive to discover late.

THE MISTAKE	WHY IT COSTS
Generating outside the project	Every asset in the film has to sit inside the submission project so the generation history verifies it. There is no folder call in the API — nothing can be moved in afterwards from code. Generate inside the project from the first frame.
Describing a face instead of dragging it	A described face drifts between frames and there is no fixing it later. Drag the handle; for anything at medium or closer, use the Soul.
Building on an unchosen frame	The account holds one image per anchor and none has been looked at. Anything chained off a skeleton frame has to be made again once the real frame is picked.
Starting a shot from the anchor still	The still is the target, not the output. Chain from the frame the previous shot actually rendered or the join will show.
Cutting inside a held shot	S10, S13 and S20 do their whole job by not cutting. Awe needs duration; a cut there destroys the only thing the shot is for.
Mixing plates on one board	Neighbouring frames inherit from whatever is nearest. One plate per board, with the bombardment shots as the one deliberate exception.
Naming a handle carelessly	The API cannot rename or delete an element. A wrong name is permanent from that side and has to be cleaned up by hand in the web app.
Leaving exploration in the project	Everything inside the project is read as part of the submission. Work the film does not use belongs outside it.

The order of everything

Gate A, identity — every reference on one screen, no face moved. Then the anchors, board by board, batch of four and select one. Gate B, the string — all 39 anchors on one contact sheet in film order. Gate C, timing — runtime, shot count and order frozen. Then the cheap motion pass, then Gate D. Then the final pass, then Gate E, picture lock, after which nothing is generated again. Sound, watermark, packshot, public post, and submit with a full day in hand.